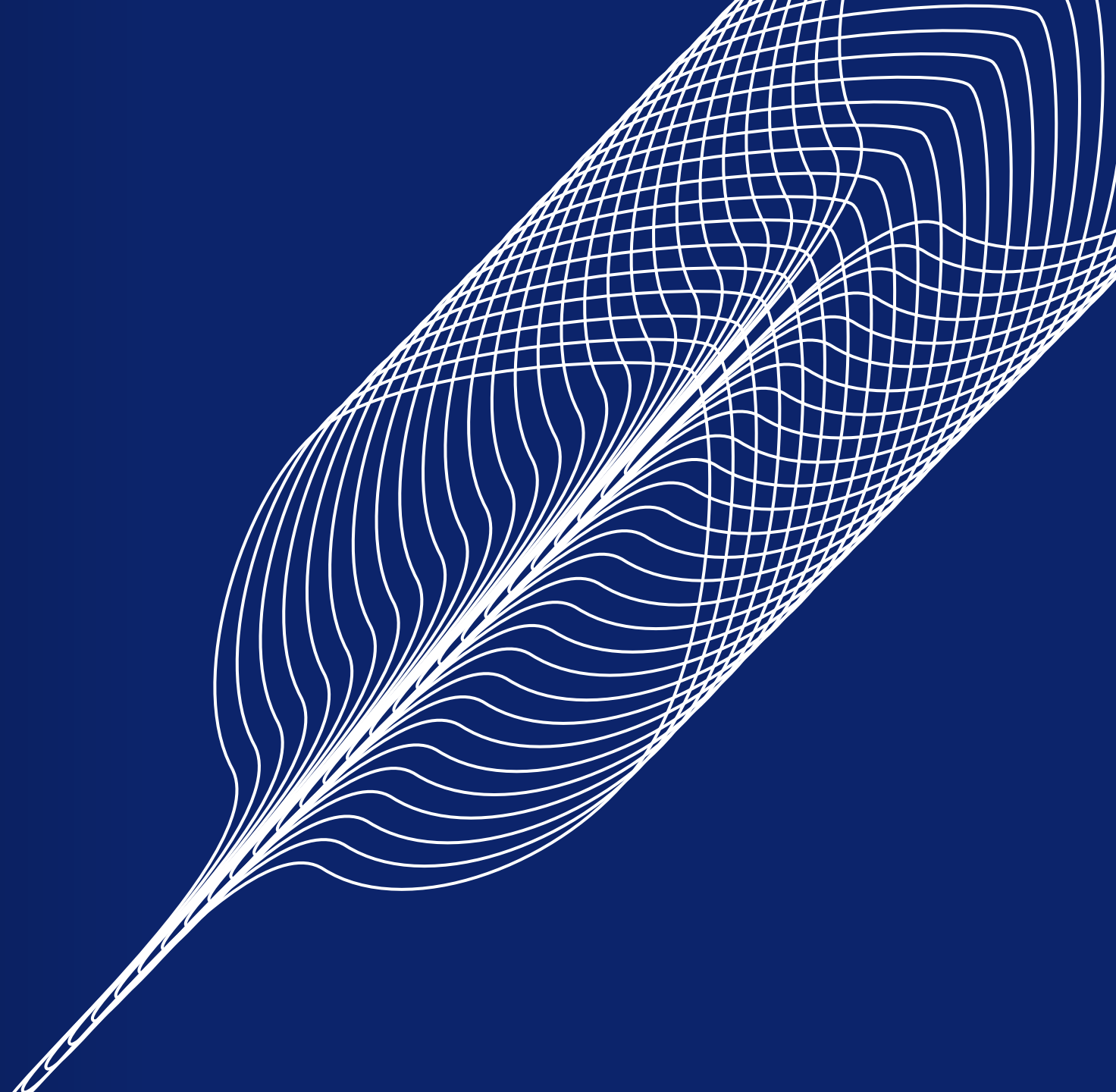
Hamilton
CONSULTING GROUP

What is Management Consulting?

March 1, 2026

4:00 pm, KJ 127



Introductions

Structured Advice without the Decision

A friend says something feels wrong in their relationship and asks for help.

Your process:

1. Clarify the problem
2. Separate facts from reactions
3. Identify patterns and causes
4. Compare options, trade-offs, and risks

Your recommendations

“Here’s what I think is happening, and here are your strongest options”

You provide and objective recommendation. They decide.

What is Management Consulting?

The definition & function of consulting, what the work looks like, what a consulting career looks like, and the industry landscape.

Consulting Sells Clarity Under Uncertainty

Consultants are external advisors hired to structure ambiguity and inform high-stakes decisions.

Uncertainty		
Margins are compressing—what is driving it?	How much should we invest to enter this new market?	How do we reposition before competitors overtake us?

↓

Structured Analysis		
Diagnose root cause	Quantify financial impact	Test strategic options

↓

Executive Recommendation	
Clear position: “we recommend..."	Risks, tradeoffs, implementation path

“Consultants advise. Management decides.”

Engagements Vary by Scope

Engagement: a time-bound client project with a clearly defined problem, workplan, and deliverables

Defined Scope
- Clear problem statement with explicit boundaries and agreed upon deliverables

Fixed Timeline
- A few weeks to multiple months. Regular milestones and consistent check-ins.

Small Teams
- 2-6 consultants, heavy collaboration and ownership, strong feedback culture.

Executive Deliverables
- Recommendations to executives, presenting findings and way forwards.

Strategy
- Market entry
- Growth strategy
- Portfolio decisions
- PE diligence

Operation
- Cost reduction
- Pricing optimization
- Supply chain redesign
- Margin improvement

Transformation
- Org redesign
- Digital overhaul
- Turnaround strategy
- Culture shifts

Due Diligence
- Financial investigation
- Investment recs
- Operational diligence
- Commercial diligence

Work: Structured, Fast, and Collaborative

Strategy (~6-12 weeks) | Operations (~3-9 months) | Transformation (~12-24 months)

Diagnose

- Align on the real decision
- Define scope + success metrics
- Form an initial hypothesis

Analyze

- Break problems into MECE components
- Run targeted analyses
- Iterate with client feedback

Recommend

- Take a clear position
- Quantify the impact and risks
- Outline implementation roadmap

Careers in Consulting Accelerate Early

Early Responsibility

- Y1 Client Exposure
- Direct interactions with senior leadership
- Ownership of workstreams
- Small-team accountability

Skill Compression

- Hypothesis-driven thinking
- MECE approach
- Professional communication
- Quantitative rigor
- High-frequency feedback

Exit Optionality

- Private equity & investing
- Venture / startups
- Corporate strategy & leadership
- Public sector / policy
- Grad school / academia

Consultants are promoted on demonstrated capability—or encouraged to pursue opportunities elsewhere

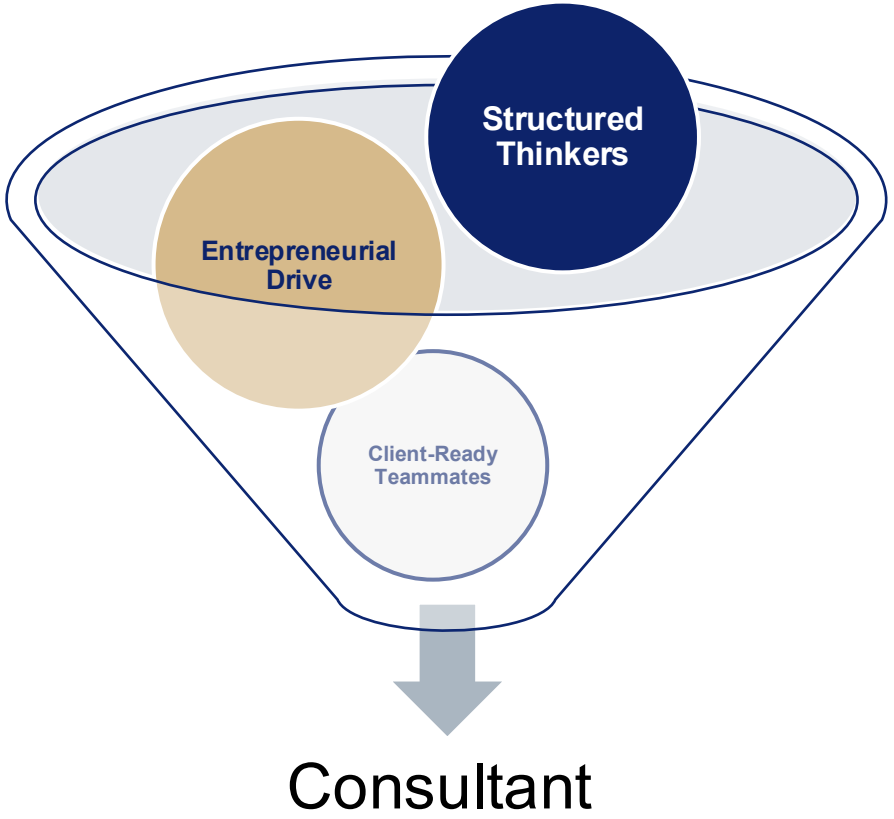
The Industry, Tiers and Designations



Who Thrives & Why Hamilton

What firms select for, the growing liberal arts edge, how Hamilton specifically positions you, and what resources there are here.

Selection is Structural



Structured Thinkers

Break ambiguity into components

Entrepreneurial Drive

Take ownership and move the work forwards.

Client-Ready Teammates

Internal and external communication that builds trust.

Bob Sternfels on Liberal Arts' Edge vs AI

15:44

- Truly novel thinking
- Unique education background
- Creativity



Hamilton Trains the Untrainable

Communication



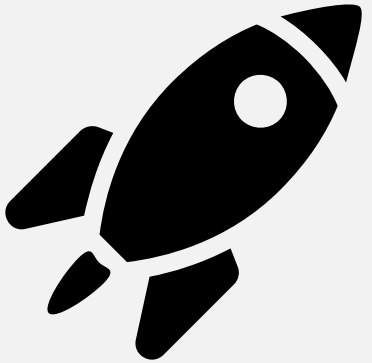
- Writing-intensives, etc.
- Seminar & discussions
- Collaboration through athletics, orgs, clubs

Intellectual Rigor



- Open curriculum
- Quantitative and qualitative
- Defending arguments

Drive

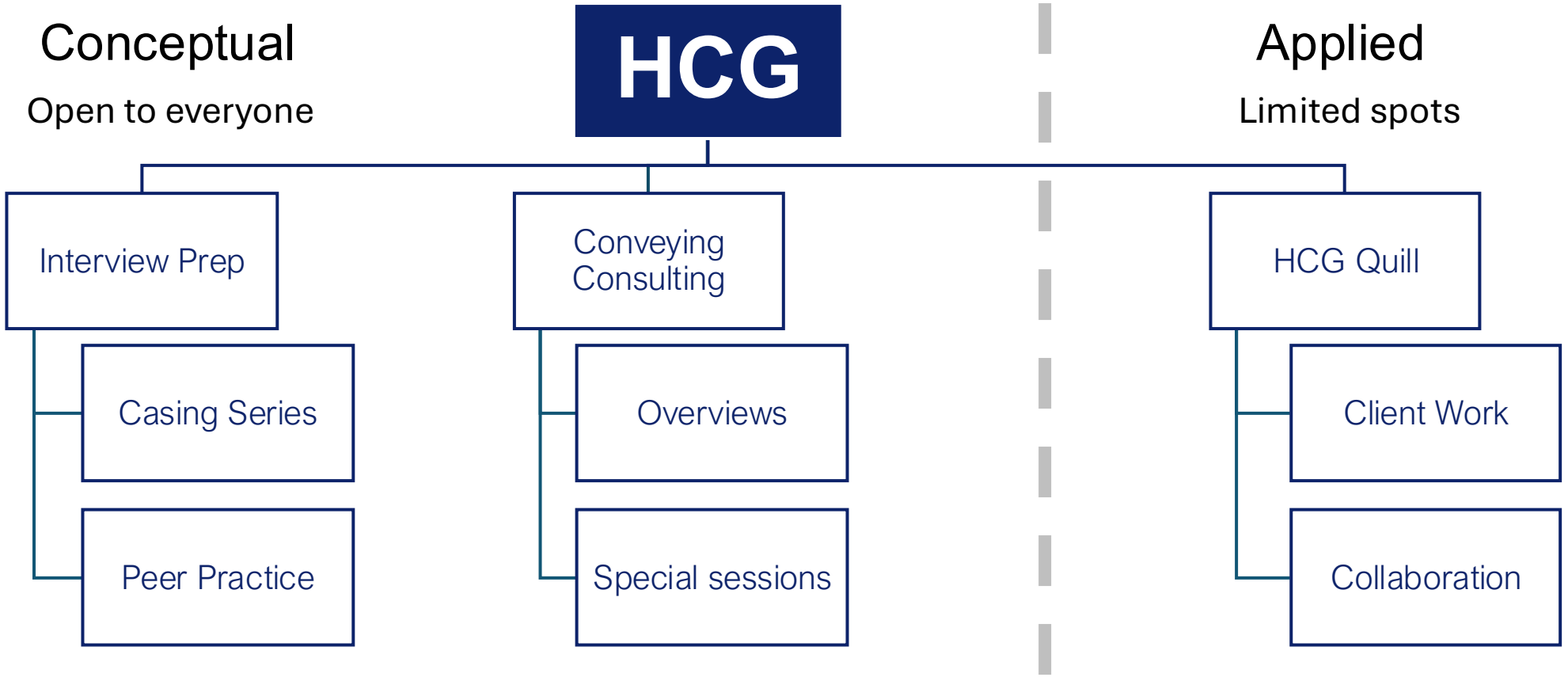


- Direct accountability
- Independent opportunities
- Leadership & impact

Institutional Infrastructure

Hamilton		
Alumni Connections	The Career Center	Hamilton Consulting Group

Hamilton Consulting Group



How do You Break In?

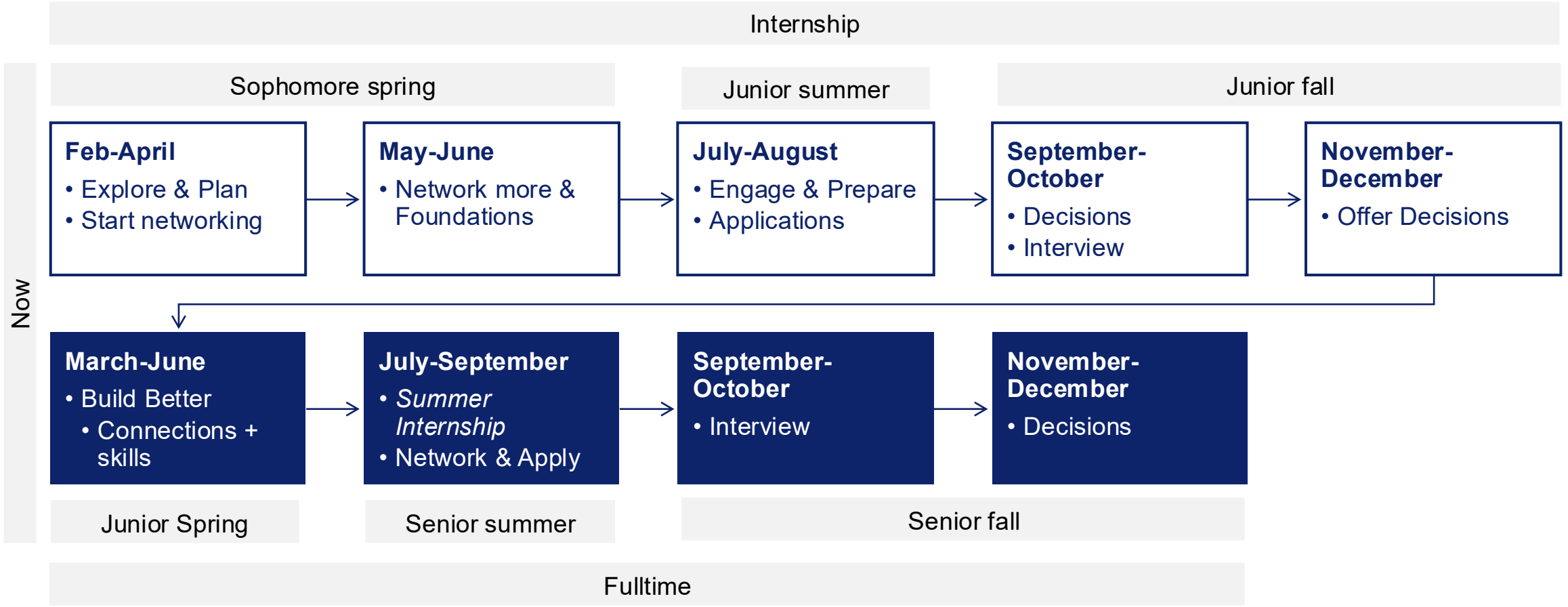
What access exists at Hamilton, recruiting timelines, experience, and the case interview.

Access Exists at Hamilton



The learning, tools, and opportunities are here — their value depends on you.

Recruiting is Timeline-Driven



Firms Select for Experience

Resume Signals (before)

What firms can see before meeting you.

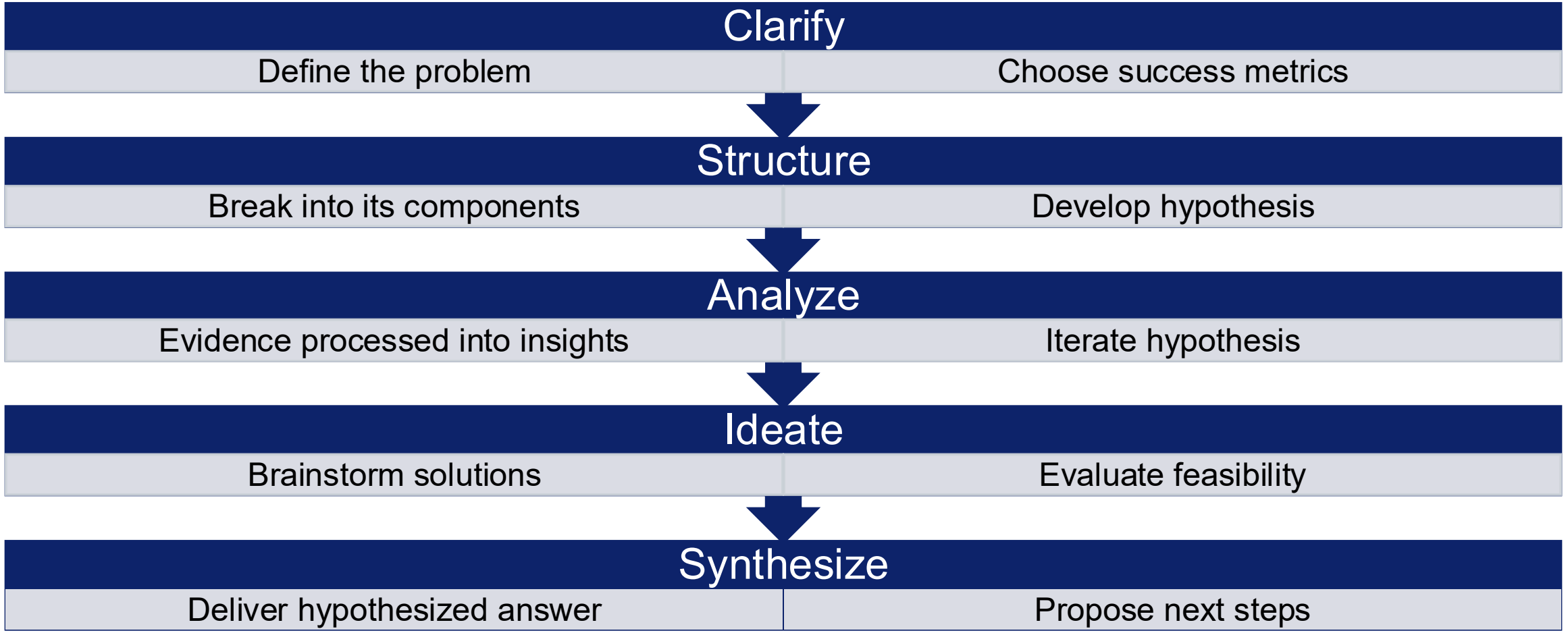
- Measurable, quantifiable impact (revenue, growth, efficiency)
- Leadership scope
- Selectivity / rigor
- Sustained commitment
- Brand associations

Experience Narratives (during)

What emerges once you speak in person

- Clear “why consulting” logic
- Consistent career arc
- Self-awareness
- Judgment under ambiguity
- Confidence without arrogance

The Case Interview.



Next Steps

What you can do following this meeting.

Succes is Trained

Now

- Get involved in HCG
- Map target firms
- Review recruiting timelines

Next

- Nick Solano ’14 workshop
- Draft 3-4 leadership/impact stories
- Reach out to alumni

Future

- Case interview reps
- Practice core skills
- Work on resumes and applications

Q&A

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